

INDEPENDENT · READER-FUNDED · MADE IN CHATTANOOGA

The Scenic City Insider

Your weekly field guide to the people building Chattanooga.

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Morning, Scenic City.

Last week’s first issue landed in a few hundred inboxes — and a startling number of you hit reply. My inbox is now a very long, very delicious list of your favorite local spots, and I’ve already eaten my way through three of them. Keep them coming; the best of this newsletter is going to come from you.

Here’s what’s worth knowing this week.

YOU TOLD US

A few of the spots you wrote in about last week.

“The sourdough at Niedlov’s.” Said by roughly half of you, with feeling. (More on Niedlov’s below — you read my mind.)

“Sully’s Crepe Co. on the Northshore.” Two readers independently insisted I go for the savory crepes, then come back for the sweet. Noted, and obeyed.

“Velo Coffee.” A small-batch roaster whose name is French for ‘bicycle’ — quietly one of the most sustainability-minded outfits in town. Consider it on the list.

WHAT'S NEW AROUND TOWN

“Openings, closings, and comings-and-goings.”

↗ **Now open — Outpost Bar & Restaurant** (Southside). The Appalachian-leaning sister to Basecamp; come for the porch, stay for the cooking.

Worth knowing — WanderLinger Brewing keeps stacking its calendar with live music and songwriter nights on the Southside. A good reminder that a taproom can be a stage, too.

Still watching — No word yet on the **Zarzour's Café** reopening. We're keeping a chair warm and will tell you the morning that screen door swings open again.

Heard about an opening or a closing before we did? **Hit reply** — you're our best reporters.

MEET A MAKER

Niedlov's Bakery & Café

Main Street · Erik & Lauren Zilen

You crowned its sourdough last week, so let's talk about the people behind it. Erik and Lauren Zilen took over Niedlov's in 2016 and turned a beloved bakery into a quiet model of how to run one. They **hire people coming out of incarceration**, giving folks a real second start; they source from more than a dozen local producers; and they compost something like **1,300 pounds of food waste a month**.

It's the kind of business that makes a city better just by existing — and yes, the loaves are exceptional. Go early; the good stuff goes fast.

BLOCK BY BLOCK

This week: St. Elmo

A short tour of one neighborhood at a time.

Tucked at the foot of Lookout Mountain where the Incline Railway begins its climb, **St. Elmo** still feels like a small town that wandered into the city. The South Broad strip is all locally owned storefronts and a classic-diner pace — the kind of block where the shopkeepers know your dog's name before they know yours.

It's having a quiet moment as new independents move in alongside the old guard. Park once, walk the strip, ride the Incline for the view, and you've got a full Saturday without ever touching the interstate. Got a St. Elmo favorite we should know? Reply and tell us.

THE INSIDER'S PICKS

What we'd do this week

Free or close to it.

Wednesday · Main Street Farmers Market (Southside) — produce, prepared food, and the city’s makers, every week.

Friday · Nightfall free concert at Miller Park downtown. Pack a chair; peek at the week’s lineup first.

Saturday · Beat the heat with a morning hike up **Stringer’s Ridge** — an in-town trail network with one of the best free skyline views in Chattanooga.

Sunday · The **Chattanooga Market** at First Horizon Pavilion (11–4). If you only do one thing on this list, do this one.

OPEN TAB

A few small things worth knowing.

A shop to know: I Go Tokyo on Frazier — a tiny, joyful trove of Japanese stationery, cookware, and goods. Easy to lose half an hour in.

A pantry upgrade: Alchemy Spice Co. makes micro-batch seasoning blends right here — the fastest way to put a little Chattanooga in your kitchen.

Heat check: it’s late June, which means roughly 90° and humid. The river breeze on the Northshore and the shade on the ridges are your friends. Hydrate; we need you for issue 003.

Still ad-free, still working for you. If issue 002 earned a few minutes of your morning, the kindest thing you can do is **forward it to one friend** — and keep those replies coming.

Founding memberships open soon, for readers who want to help fund an independent guide to this city. More on that shortly.

Yours in the Scenic City,

[Your Name]

Founder & Insider-in-Chief

The Scenic City Insider

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